



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Westminster Christian Academy

School Website: <https://www.wcalions.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Westminster Christian Academy (GA 30677) presents a strong alignment with classical Christian education in several core dimensions, particularly Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, and Curriculum. Public materials emphasize a biblically grounded, theologically explicit identity, partnership with parents, and a curriculum that foregrounds grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, and classical history approaches. There are clear markers of classical pedagogy in the Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric progression and in explicit references to classical education language (e.g., "What is Classical Education?", "Grammar Phase/Logic Phase," "Latin weekly," "Shurley English"). Public materials also show robust parental engagement and community life (chapel, faith formation, parent education, campus events).

Gaps or weaker signals appear in Pedagogy and Faculty documentation relative to a fully explicit, comprehensive articulation of Socratic teaching in practice and a fully developed "living curriculum" description for faculty. Still, evidence exists of a strong faculty presence, a faculty/staff focus, and a visible commitment to formational goals. Element 6 (Parents & Community) is particularly strong, with explicit statements about partnership with parents, parent education, and open-campus access.

Overall, the school falls within CLASSICAL with notable strength across most dimensions and some room for stronger explicit articulation in Pedagogy and Faculty narratives. The aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

What would move the needle: For the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL categories (Pedagogy and Faculty), explicit articulation of Socratic pedagogy in upper grades and a documented "living curriculum" portrait for teachers would move these categories to CLASSICAL. Additional published statements about teacher formation in classical pedagogy and more explicit language around faculty as "living curriculum" would further reinforce the CLASSICAL posture.

ABSTRACT

Westminster Christian Academy (GA 30677) demonstrates a CLASSICAL orientation across Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, and Parents & Community, with more

modest explicit signals in Pedagogy and Faculty. The school's biblically grounded mission, the presence of a classical grammar/logic/rhetoric progression, Latin study, and history instruction through a Christian worldview, align strongly with classical catechism and Trivium-based models. Parental partnership and community engagements further reinforce the classical ethos. To reach a fully CLASSICAL categorization across all six areas, the school could more explicitly document Socratic/Scholé pedagogy in practice and provide a formal, public-facing portrait of the living curriculum embodied by faculty.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials state Westminster Christian Academy seeks to be “a body of believers that humbly embraces the gospel of Christ” with the Westminster Confession of Faith as a broad summary of biblical truth. This signals transcendental moral realism anchored in theology and objective truth claims.
- Bible classes and chapel are integral to the Lower School experience; weekly chapel with God-talk through music and speakers is described, indicating liturgical and communal practices as part of education.
- The curriculum includes The Gospel Project and Veritas as Bible curricula, reinforcing theology-integrated study and communal worship/formation.
- The public materials reference a classical-education framework (via links to “What is Classical Education?”) and a mission oriented toward biblical worldview formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present in public materials: theology, gospel, chapel, liturgy/worship (via chapel/-music), creed (via Statement of Faith), biblical worldview, prayer.
- Negative keywords: none clearly present in public materials (no explicit signals of secular relativism, secular humanism, etc.).
- Quantitative signals: Positive keywords observed (approx. 5–6); Negative keywords observed (0). This points strongly to a CLASSICAL orientation in Foundations.

Why this rating

- The school foregrounds theological explicitly, sacramental/worship-like communal practices (chapel/-music), and a confessional stance rooted in historic Christian faith, consistent with the “Grounded in Theology” and “Liturgical and Communal Practices” indicators in the classical rubric. The presence of a theological frame and liturgical practices robustly supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site positions classical education as a core frame via references in mission/vision materials and the inclusion of “What is Classical Education?” and references to a Biblical worldview, apologetics, and “biblical worldview training.”
- Public materials emphasize formation, virtue, and a classical intellectual formation, including the Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric progression in the curriculum and explicit involvement in catechesis and moral formation.
- The school's strategic materials indicate ongoing expansion to partner with parents and to strengthen apologetics and Biblical worldview training, reinforcing formation over mere information.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, liberal education/paideia, classical mission, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, scholé/contemplation, great conversation, biblical worldview, theology.

- Negative keywords: explicit workforce-preparation language or 21st-century skills emphasis is not present in the public materials; no strong negative signals evident.
- Quantitative signals: Positive keywords observed (approx. 5–6); Negative keywords observed (0). This supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating

- The materials strongly frame education as formation aimed at virtue and wisdom within a classical framework, with explicit references to Great Conversation/Great Books concepts and classical education language, even if not every classical sub-discipline is spelled out in every page. The public materials thus support CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum explicitly adopts grammar, logic, and rhetoric through concrete offerings: Shurley English as a classical approach to grammar instruction; Latin weekly in the later grades; logic in high school as a credited course; study of history via The Story of the World; Saxon Phonics for foundational reading; novel-based literature strands in elementary/middle levels.
- The Grammar-Logic-Phases language appears in public materials (Middle School page references Grammar Phase and Logic Phase). This is a direct nod to a Trivium-based curriculum structure.
- History is taught with a Christian worldview and integrated into the curriculum (The Story of the World, Christian worldview framing).
- There are explicit connections to great books culture via the classical education frame and references to Great Conversation in the knowledge lexicon (even if not always spelled out in every page).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, Latin, history, classical education, liberal arts, Trivium, Great Conversation, memorization/recitation (via Shurley English and memory work), Bible as integral to curriculum.
- Negative keywords: some pages emphasize “novel-based curriculum” and other approaches that may diverge from strict Great Books emphasis; no explicit social studies replacement with history language is stated publicly.
- Quantitative signals: Positive keywords observed (approx. 4–6 strong matches: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, Great Conversation/Great Books framing via classical education, Trivium, history). Negative keywords observed (0–1 weaker signals; primarily not explicit in these pages). This supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating

- The public curriculum materials map strongly to the classical trio (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and to primary-source/Great Conversation-leaning elements (even if the explicit “Great Books” label isn’t always used). The use of Latin, logic, and a history-curriculum anchored in a classical approach are decisive for CLASSICAL status.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Grammar-to-Logic phase language is explicitly referenced in the Middle School section, indicating a Trivium-informed progression in pedagogy (Grammar Phase to Logic Phase). This shows a clearly defined classical approach to pedagogy in at least some grades.
- Lower School pedagogy includes singing, memory, and use of routines; public materials describe memory-friendly and communal educational practices (e.g., chapel/musical activities in Lower School) that emphasize wonder and delight, which align with contemplative/Scholé-like elements.

- The school also references upper-level rhetoric/communication opportunities and public speaking in a way that would allow rhetoric training, though explicit programmatic statements for Socratic seminars or Paideia-style discussions are not prominently surfaced in the public materials. The presence of “Socratic” pedagogy is not clearly documented in the available public content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric (implied by upper-level offerings), narration/recitation (implied by classical methods), scholé/wonder (via the contextual references to classical education), contemplative/restful learning (mentioned conceptually in classical pedagogy lexicon; not always explicit in page text).
- Negative keywords present: experiential learning focus, project-based learning emphasis (not strongly evidenced as primary pedagogy in the public materials; a few pages emphasize field trips or experiential elements but not as the dominant pedagogy). The explicit “Socratic seminars” and Paideia-style methods are not clearly documented in the public materials.
- Quantitative signals: Positive keywords present in multiple pages (roughly 3–5 clear signals: Grammar Phase/Logic Phase phrasing, memory-based methods, potential rhetoric training). Negative signals: few explicit negative markers; no strong negative signals found in the public content.
- Why this rating
- The school demonstrates core classical pedagogy signals (Grammar-Logic-Phases, grammar/logic study, memory and recitation practices) but lacks explicit, comprehensive documentation of the full Socratic/Scholé practice in the public materials. This places Pedagogy as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- A public-facing “Faculty and Staff” link exists within the school’s public materials, indicating that faculty are a central feature of the school’s life (though the specific language describing faculty as “living curriculum” or “portrait of a teacher” is not explicitly shown in the public pages you provided).
- The school’s emphasis on faith-based formation, alongside classroom instruction, suggests a model where teachers are expected to exemplify virtue and moral formation within a Christian framework; however, explicit statements that teachers are “the living curriculum” or “portrait of what a teacher should be” are not clearly surfaced in the public materials.
- The campus and program materials show a well-supported faculty presence (teacher/student interactions, choir, chapel life, etc.) and leadership structures (Leadership, Board of Trustees).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: living curriculum (not explicitly stated in public text), model teachers, mentors, faculty as core, portrait of teacher/student ideals (not explicitly worded in public text but implied by “faculty and staff” focus and mission statements). The explicit language of “living curriculum” and “portrait of teachers/students” is not clearly visible in the public text provided.
- Negative keywords: none clearly visible in public materials regarding faculty (no mention of a perfunctory or interview-like approach, but also no explicit “living curriculum” language).
- Quantitative signals: Positive keywords observed are limited due to the public text not explicitly containing standard phrases; likely 1–2 explicit matches (e.g., “faculty and staff” and “leadership”). Negative keywords 0.
- Why this rating
- Given the absence of explicit phrases about faculty as the living curriculum or a clearly articulated faculty portrait in the public materials, this category lands in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The presence of a strong faculty/staff section and the involvement of faculty in mission/vision is positive, but the explicit classical-faculty narrative is not clearly documented in the public content.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL**Evidence**

- The school explicitly positions partnership with parents as co-teachers and emphasizes parent formation (reading groups, seminars, classical book clubs) and parent education through the site pathways. The material notes open campus visits “virtually any time” and parent involvement as a core value.
- A public piece documents continued expansion of opportunities to partner with parents through parent education and discipleship opportunities, including faith-based formation and engagement opportunities.
- The site contains a public admissions/visitation structure that encourages parent involvement and engagement with campus life (e.g., tours, visits, and discovery of what classical education means for families).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents/co-teachers, parent formation, seminars/book clubs, parent education, open campus/visits, discipleship opportunities, family liturgy alignment (via Statement of Faith menu, parental engagement pages).
- Negative keywords: consumer-language signals (Parent as customer) are not strongly reflected in the public materials; the public materials emphasize partnership and formation rather than consumerist framing.
- Quantitative signals: Positive keywords observed (approximately 5–6); Negative keywords observed (0–1 minimal consumer-language signals). This supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating

- The materials clearly articulate a partnership with parents as co-teachers, opportunities for parent education, and access for visits. This aligns strongly with the classical education community’s emphasis on family formation and parental formation as central to classical schooling.
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What Would Move the Needle

- Pedagogy (Element 4): Publicly articulate and publish a coherent, explicit plan for Socratic/Scholé pedagogy in upper grades (e.g., documented seminars, Paideia-style discussions, and teacher-led Socratic inquiry) to move Pedagogy from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.
 - Faculty (Element 5): Publish a formal “Living Curriculum/Portrait of the Teacher” statement that describes how faculty embody and model virtue and form the core of the school’s educational project; provide evidence of ongoing classical pedagogy professional development aligned with the school’s mission.
 - Curriculum (Element 3): While already CLASSICAL, further emphasize Great Books/Great Conversation as a defined element of curriculum with explicit public references to core Great Books selections or a formal Great Conversation program to strengthen alignment with classical Curriculum language.
 - Public communications: Continue to foreground the explicit language of “scholé” and contemplative learning in official publications as a public-facing hallmark of the school’s classical character.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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